

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2018

Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 31)

- 13-15: 3 points for each correct sentence. (max 9)
 - 1 less for each wrong word, till zero.
- 16-18: 1 point for each correct word. (max 22)
 - No half marks.

13	I hear a moon below you.
14	You shake the clam next to your owl.
15	We do not see your banana in front of my sons.
16	yangna dakinawan balna mukusni balna kurarahwaski yangna taakitna yak.
17	wasni yaihnit yak sunilu palani yamtaman.
18	pinsil balna buitayang manna titinghmana minit yak.

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Commentary

Syntax

(PP) S O (PP) V (PP) word order

PP (marked by locative marker *yak*) can appear in all positions except between S and O.

Nouns

Definite + possessive markers for nouns are infixes with the nouns. There is no phonological rule for the location of the infixing, but instead each word has a specific location where all infixes go. For example, the word *su-lu* (dog) has all infixes placed in between the two syllables (e.g. *sunilu* = the dog, *sukilu* = my dog, etc).

Plural is expressed with the word *balna* which follows the word.

	1st person	2nd person	3rd person
Singular	-ki-	-ma-	-ni- (also the definite article)
Plural	-kina-	-mana-	-nina-

In the case of the location words, the plural affix -na- is suffixed (e.g. mi-**ki-t-na**).

Possession: Possessor + Possessee (marked as above)

Two location words also undergo vowel harmonising in the 2nd person (mi-ma-t > mamat, di-ma-t > damat).

Verbs

positive negative	1st	2nd	3rd
Singular	-(ta)yang -(ta)syang	-(ta)man -(ta)sman	-wi -waski
Plural	-(ta)yangna -(ta)syangna	-(ta)manna -(ta)smanna	as 3s but with stem reduplication

In the 3rd person plural, the final syllable of the stem is reduplicated:

tal > tatal
yam > yayam
(bui > bubui)
kurah > kurarah

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kas > kakas

dakaa > dakakaa

The syllable coda/vowel length is deleted in the reduplication. The -ta- suffix is not present in the verbs *hear* or *see* (the fact they are both verbs of perception is actually a coincidence).